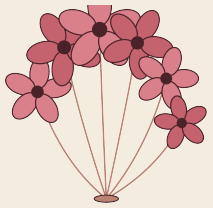
Petal Ping

Product Brief · AI Builder Space Proseminar

Elle Brauchle, MBA Candidate at MIT Sloan '28



September 30, 2026

Petal Ping is an integration tool that pulls real menstrual cycle and symptom data from health apps to deliver tailored, research-backed notifications and trend insights — built solo as a free, personalized alternative to tracking tools that are either too limited or too costly.

SECTION 1

Basics

Project: Petal Ping | **Creator:** Elle Brauchle (solo project) | **Type:** integration tool

SECTION 2

The Idea & The User

Petal Ping is an integration tool that connects with existing health apps (Apple Health, Flo, etc.) to track menstrual cycles and symptoms, and delivers tailored push notifications — heads-up reminders for upcoming cycles or symptoms, research-backed health tips, and alerts when trends emerge. A companion app displays this information, with an export option for medical appointments. It begins as a personal tool for Elle, with potential to expand to anyone managing periods — especially those with challenging or irregular cycles, or anyone interested in tracking long-term trends — and eventually to other health-tracking needs beyond menstrual cycles. This is a “better version” opportunity: existing tools like Apple Health offer only basic cycle prediction with limited symptom logging, while more robust options (like Flo) are typically paid. Petal Ping aims to combine tracking, tailored insights, and trend alerts in one free, personalized tool.

SECTION 3

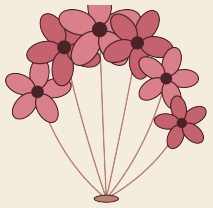
Existing Options

Similar tools exist in the market, including Apple Health's native cycle tracking and paid apps like Flo and Natural Cycles. However, Petal Ping is intentionally being built from scratch rather than adopted from an existing option. This is a deliberate “build it myself” choice, driven by a mix of factors: a desire to learn how to vibe code and build something genuinely useful in the process, a belief that the tool will directly benefit its creator, and a preference to avoid recurring paid subscriptions. Existing options don't fit this context well enough to justify using them instead.

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SECTION 4

Scope for This Sprint

The smallest useful version of Petal Ping for this sprint focuses on getting real, working data flowing through to tailored notifications.

Must-haves

- Pull real cycle/symptom data from a health app (Apple Health has posed integration challenges; Flo's or Natural Cycle's free versions will be evaluated as the primary data source)
- Predictive heads-up notifications for upcoming cycles/symptoms
- Research-backed health tips delivered via notification (sourced from uploaded articles/linked references)

Out of scope (nice-to-haves if time allows)

- Trend alerts
- Basic export option for medical appointments
- Fully built-out companion app (a minimal version to browse past/upcoming notifications is a stretch goal, not required)

SECTION 5

What Does Success Look Like?

Success for this sprint means the integration successfully pulls real data and sends at least one real predictive notification and one research-backed tip notification. Because cycle tracking works on a by-month basis, full validation of predictive accuracy may not be possible within the sprint window — that will be assessed as data accumulates over time. Ideal notification frequency is still to be determined and is logged as an open question.

SECTION 6

Open Questions or Risks

- Whether Apple Health, Flo, or Natural Cycle's free version will serve as the data source, given Apple Health integration issues
- Level of effort required to pull data — manual export vs. an automated daily-pull connection
- Data quality depends on how much and what type of info the user logs; no known app currently supports open-text symptom notes
- Ideal notification frequency is undetermined
- How to incorporate user feedback (e.g., thumbs up/down per notification) to train the model on preferred alerts — unclear whether this happens upfront or iteratively post-launch